UNDER CONSTRUCTION



Tablet App for Mac

User manual · Version 6

macOS on Apple silicon · 2026-10-23

Version 6. British English. Screens are real screenshots from a Mac running earlier versions, so some may differ slightly.

Before you start

Tested only on an Apple silicon Mac with macOS 27.0.1 and a Wacom Intuos4 Small (PTK-440). Other systems and tablets are untested. Use at your own risk.

Quick start

- Quit the Wacom driver if it is running (see Wacom driver conflict).
- Open Tablet App for Mac. Allow **Input Monitoring** and **Accessibility** when macOS asks.
- On **Home**, check the tablet card shows your tablet as connected.
- Open the tablet, choose **Pen** in the Tool row, and set **Tip Feel**.
- Set **Mapping** to the display you draw on.
- Under **Functions**, set the ExpressKeys and the **Touch ring** modes.
- Click **Save** in the footer. Unsaved changes are kept and offered again after a shutdown.
- Test in **Scribble**.

Introduction and requirements

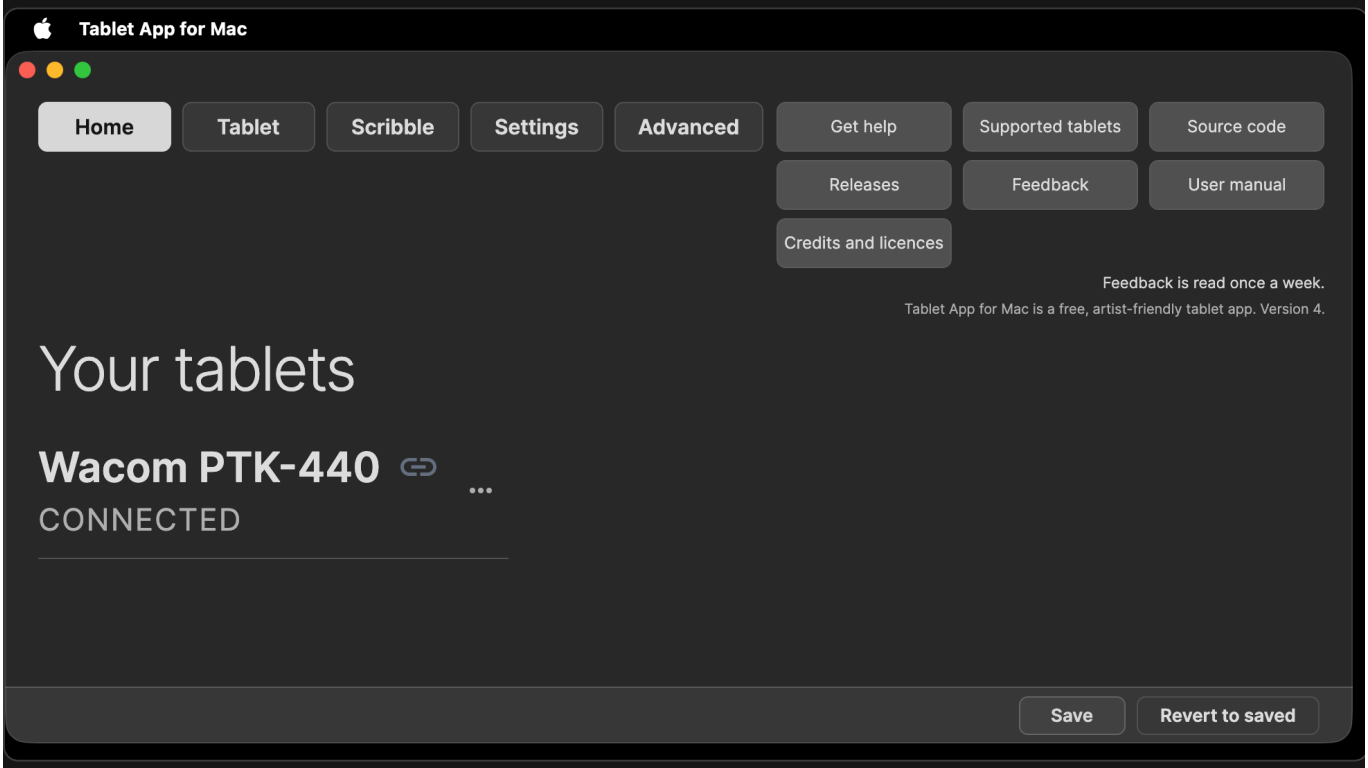
Tablet App for Mac sets up a pen tablet on macOS: pen feel, buttons, mapping, ExpressKeys and Touch Ring modes, with per-app settings. Tablet input comes from the OpenTabletDriver daemon, which the app starts.

- A Mac with Apple silicon.
- The OpenTabletDriver daemon (included in the app).
- Input Monitoring and Accessibility permissions (Accessibility is called Device Control and Data Access on macOS 27).
- Uninstall the Wacom driver first, as both can't run at once.

Install and first launch

- Copy **Tablet App for Mac** to Applications and open it.
- macOS asks for **Input Monitoring** (to read the tablet) and **Accessibility** (to send keys and clicks). Allow both in System Settings › Privacy & Security, then relaunch the app.
- The app starts its OpenTabletDriver daemon. The menu bar icon stays while it runs.
- At login the app starts silently: only the pen icon in the menu bar shows. Click it to open the window.
- Only one copy runs. Opening the app again brings the running copy to the front.

Home



Home

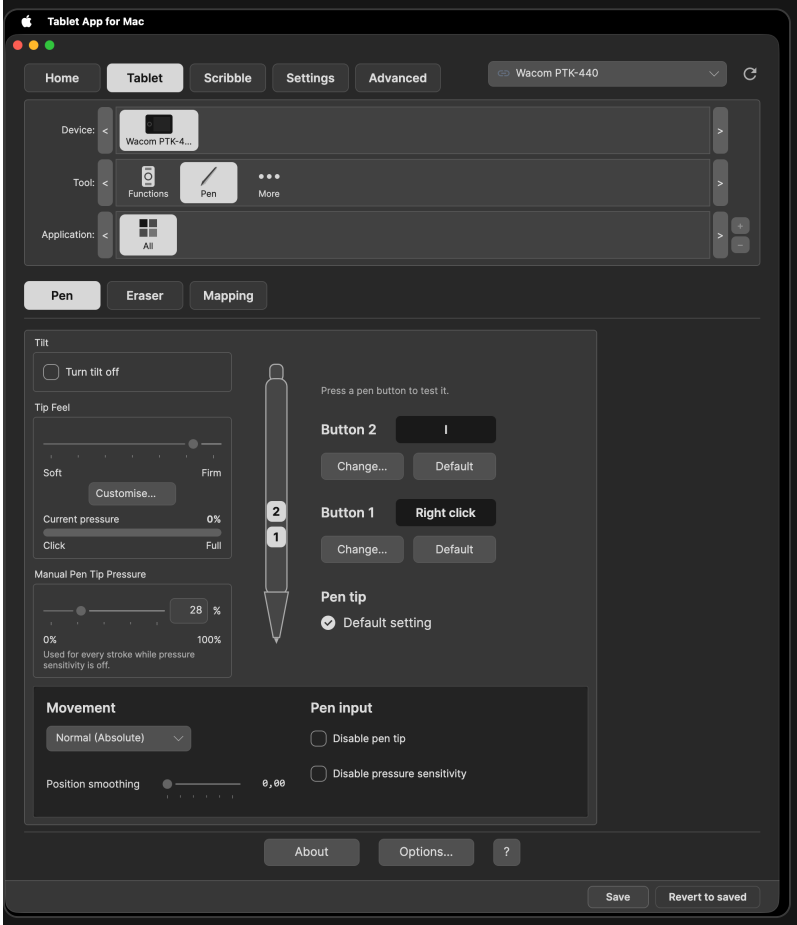
- **Your tablets**: one card per connected or remembered tablet. Click a card to open its settings.
- Card ⋯ menu: **Open tablet settings**, **Forget this tablet**.

- Health rows: problems found, each with **Fix** or a specific action where one exists. **Fix** works with the pen even while the pen tip or eraser is disabled.
- **Open daemon page**: shown when the daemon is not reachable.

Tablet page layout

- **Device**: the selected tablet. The switcher lists connected and remembered tablets.
- **Tool**: **Functions** (ExpressKeys, Touch ring), **Pen** (pen, eraser, mapping), **More** (about, calibration, hover, filters, json).
- **Application**: **All**, or a specific app. **+** adds an app with its own settings; **−** removes it.
- **Refresh** reloads the tablet's settings from the daemon.
- Footer: **Options…** (Settings), **?** (this manual).

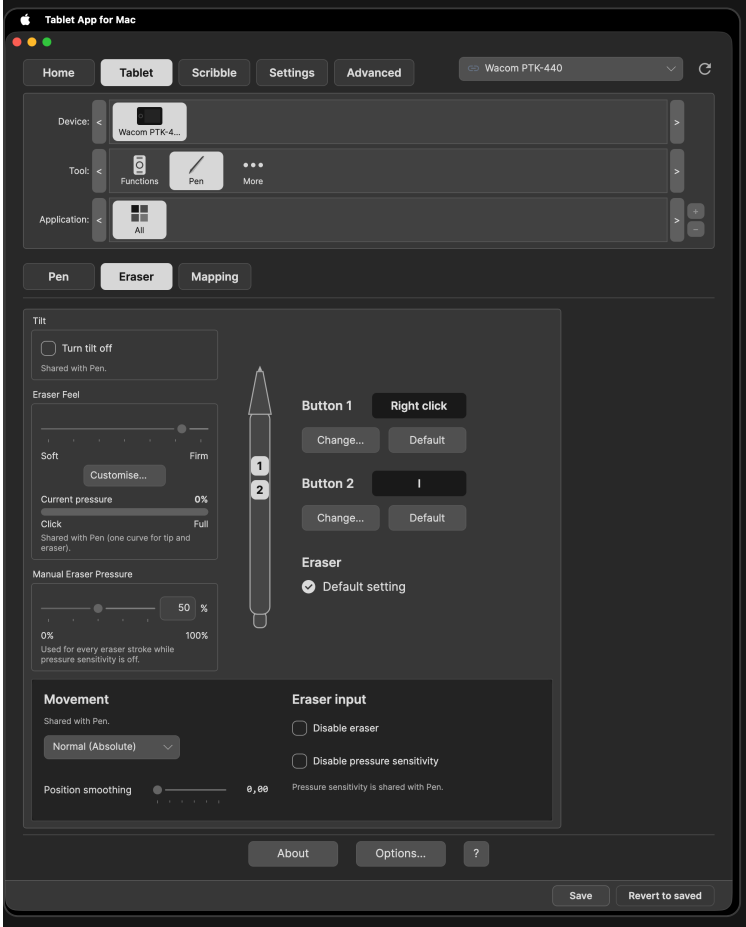
Tablet › Pen



Pen

Control	Default	Function
Tilt › Turn tilt off	Off	Stops sending tilt. Shared with the eraser.
Tip Feel	Middle (linear)	Soft to Firm pressure curve.
Customise…	Closed	Shows the curve, presets **Soft**, **Linear (no curve)**, **Hard**, the input range sliders and **Cut below input minimum (dead zone)** (off).
Current pressure	Live	Pressure after the curve; tooltip shows the raw value.
Button 1 / Button 2 cards	Default (right click) / Default (middle click)	**Change…** opens the function editor; **Default** restores it.
Pen button test	Live	Press a barrel button: its number on the pen picture lights while held, and the line above the cards reads "Button 2 pressed." (or 1).
Movement	Normal (Absolute)	Absolute maps the pen to the screen; Mouse (Relative) moves the cursor like a mouse.
Position smoothing	0.00	Steadies the cursor, with some lag.
Disable pen tip	Off	The tip makes no strokes; the bar reads 0%.
Disable pressure sensitivity	Off	Every stroke uses the Manual Pen Tip Pressure while pressed, in every app.
Manual Pen Tip Pressure	30%	Own frame under Tip Feel. The pressure used while pressure sensitivity is off (0 to 100%).

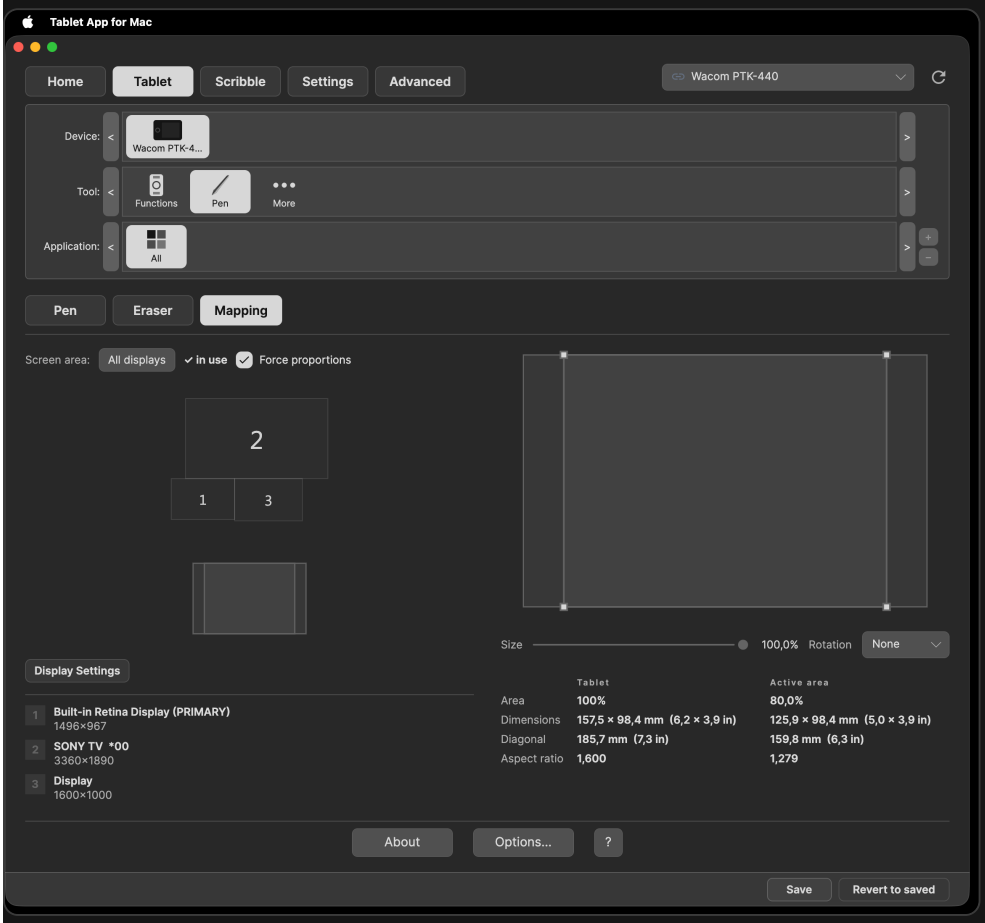
Tablet › Eraser



Eraser

The Eraser tab has the same controls as Pen. Separate for the eraser: **Disable eraser** and **Manual Eraser Pressure** (own frame under Eraser Feel; used while pressure sensitivity is off). Shared with Pen (marked "Shared with Pen"): tilt, the Feel curve (one curve for tip and eraser), pressure sensitivity, Movement and Position smoothing. The button cards are the pen's barrel buttons.

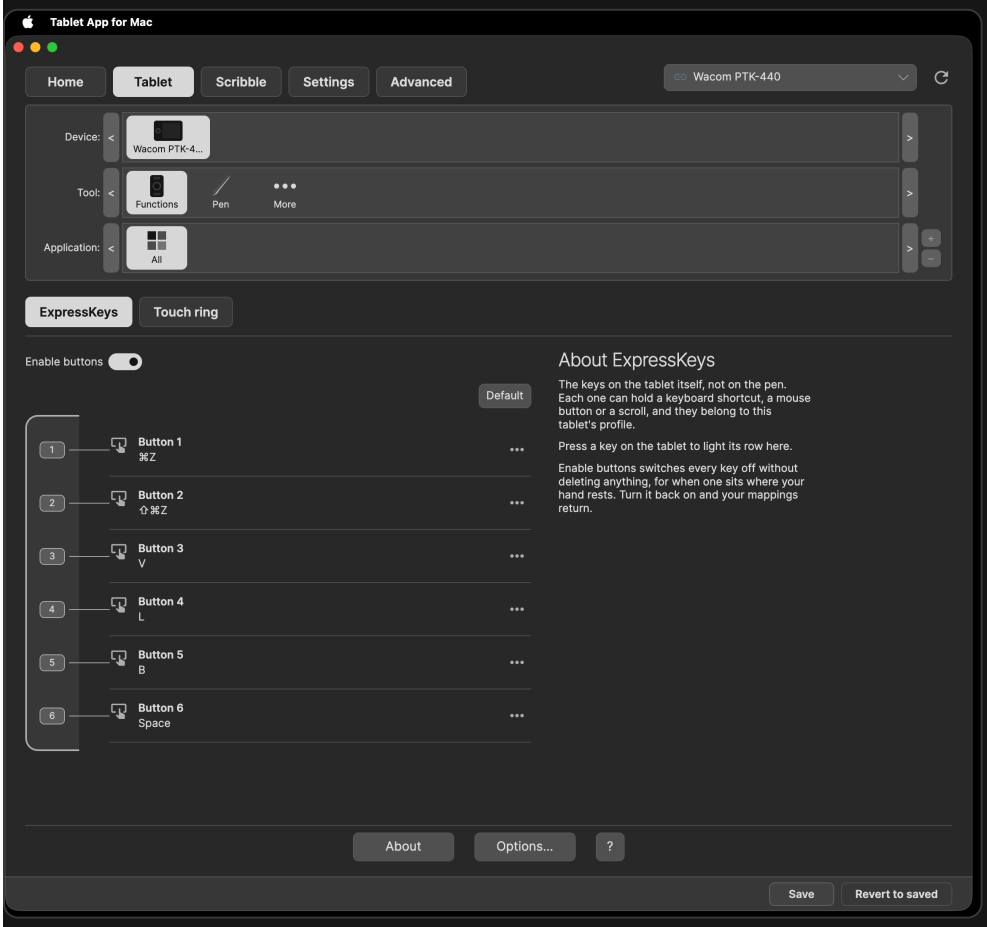
Tablet › Mapping



Mapping

Control	Default	Function
Active area	Whole tablet	Drag the area or its corners.
Rotation	0°	180° puts the ExpressKeys on the other side; 90° and 270° are portrait. Recalibrate after rotating.
Display / All displays	Main display	The display the area maps to.
Force proportions	On	Keeps the area at the display's aspect ratio.
Display Settings	–	Opens macOS Displays settings.

Tablet › Functions › ExpressKeys

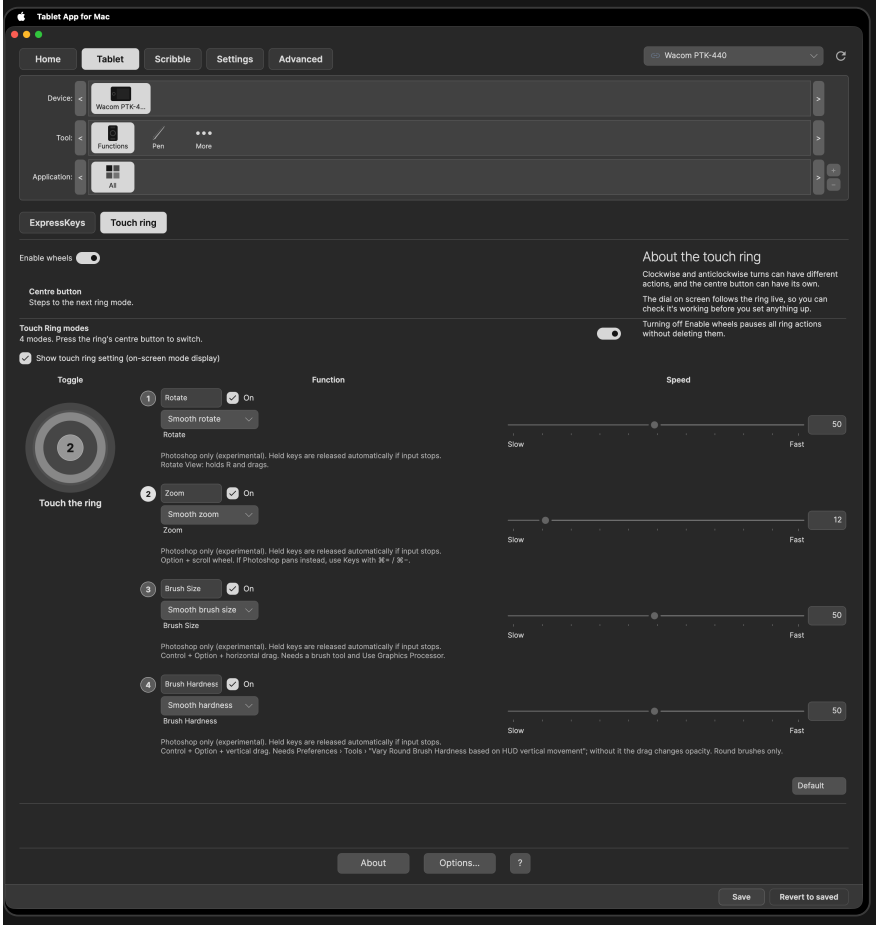


ExpressKeys

- Press a key on the tablet to light its row.
- Row ⋯: **Edit…** opens the function editor, **Clear** removes the action.
- The enable switch turns all ExpressKey actions off or on; actions are kept.
- **Default**: clears every ExpressKey action, after asking.

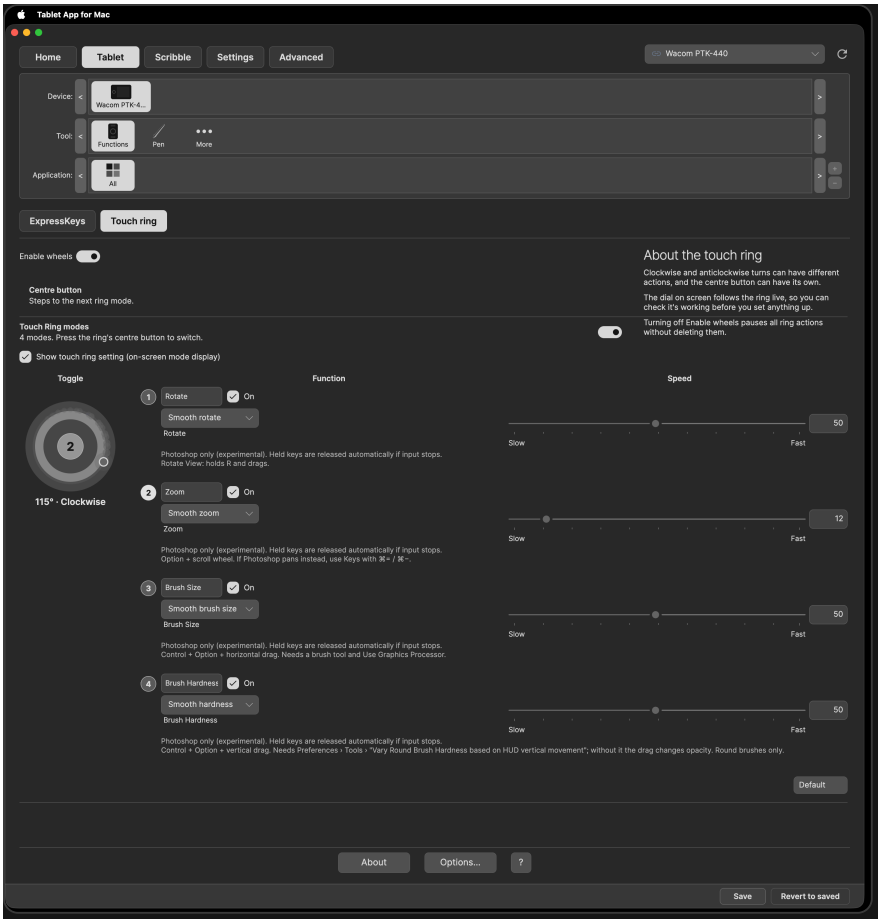
Function editor: **Keyboard** (a shortcut; Cmd, Ctrl, Shift and Option are held modifiers), **Mouse** (Left, Right, Middle click, Back and Forward button), **Scroll** (up, down, left, right), **Media** (Mute, Volume down, Volume up, Play / Pause, Previous track, Next track, Stop). **Save**, **Cancel**, **Clear**.

Tablet › Functions › Touch ring



Touch ring

- **Enable wheels**: On. Pauses all ring actions without deleting them.
- **Touch Ring modes**: On. "4 modes. Press the ring's centre button to switch."
- **Show touch ring setting (on-screen mode display)**: On. Shows the mode name when you switch.
- The dial follows the ring live: the dot sits under your finger. The angle and turn direction show under the ring, for example "0° · Clockwise". 12 o'clock is 0° and 3 o'clock is 90°.
- The active mode is highlighted; its number is lit, centred, and also shows on the centre button.



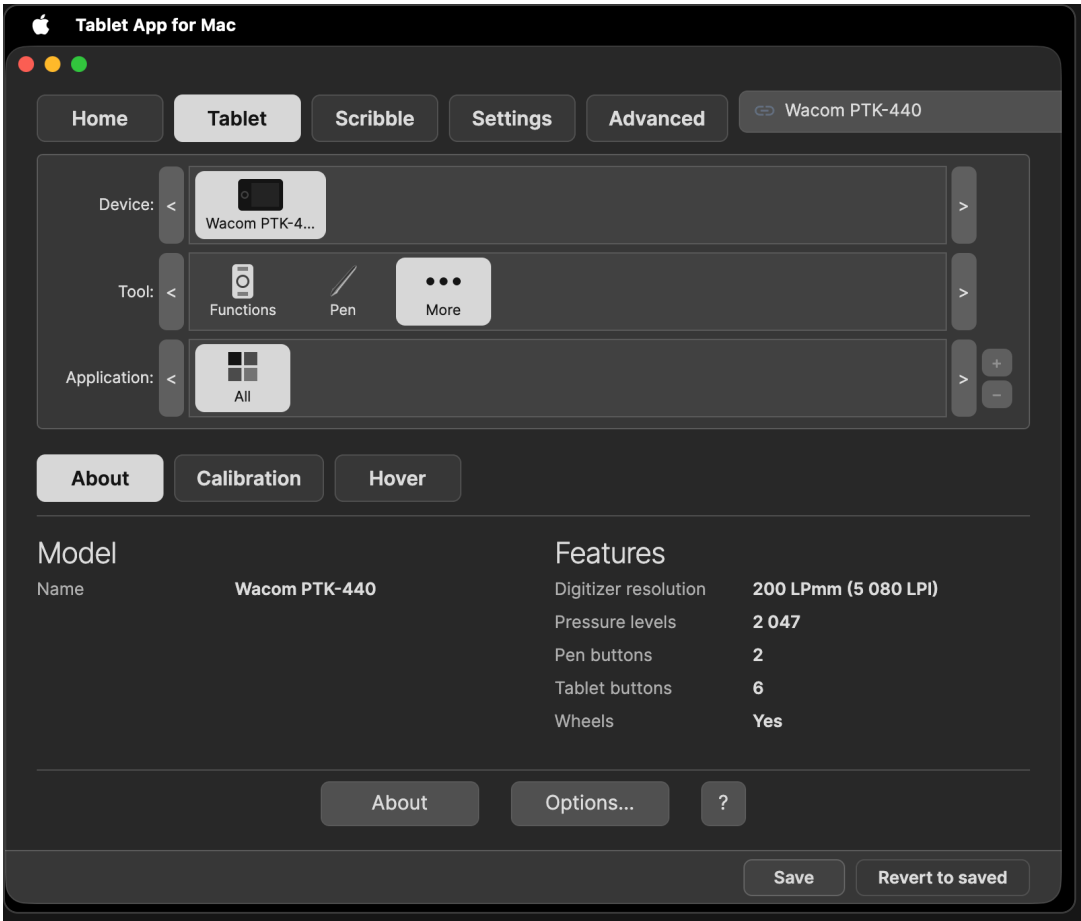
Touch ring in use

- On-screen centre button: moves the highlight to the next mode. The tablet's centre button switches the driver's mode.
- Per mode: name, **On**, **Function** (Keystroke…, or the experimental drag actions, Photoshop only), **Speed** (Slow to Fast, slider or typed), and the **Clockwise** and **Anticlockwise** keys.
- **Default** restores the four modes:

Mode	Clockwise	Anticlockwise	Every
Rotate	Option+F13	Option+F14	10°
Zoom	Cmd+=	Cmd+−	30°
Brush size	]	[	8°
Brush hardness	Shift+]	Shift+[	60°

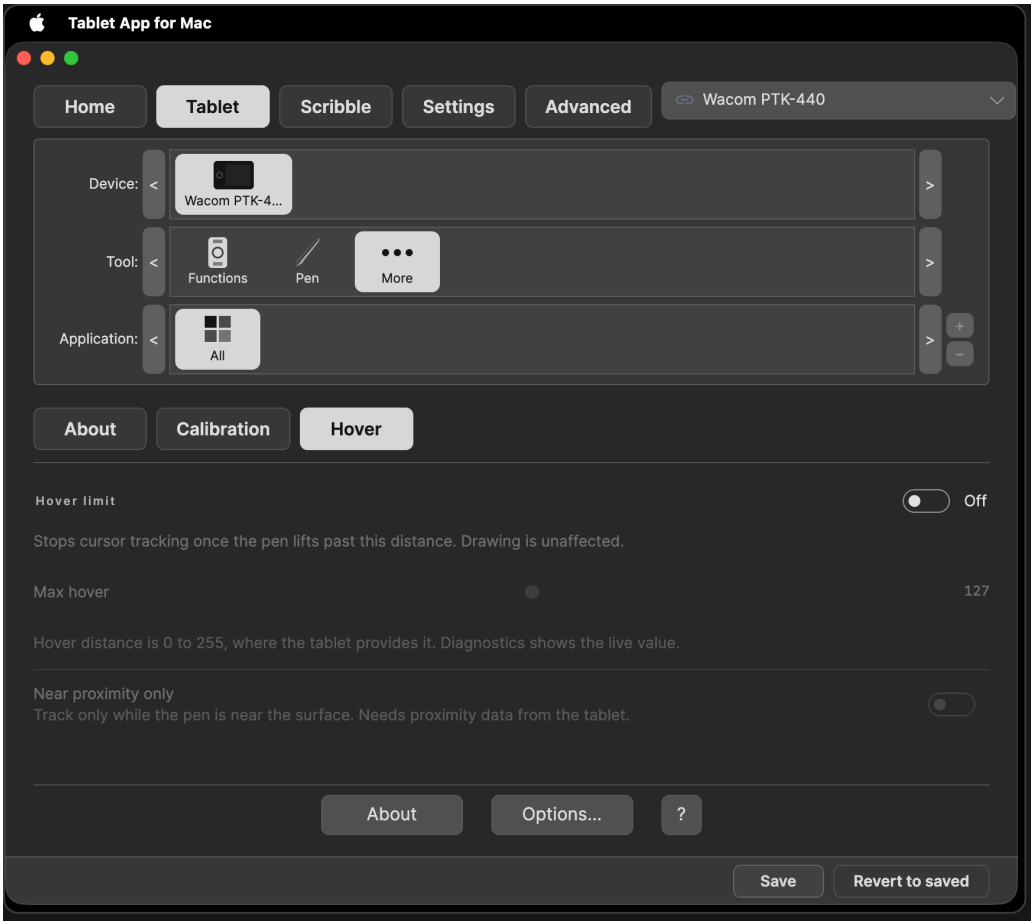
Tablet › More

- **about**: the tablet's model and features: digitiser resolution, pressure levels, pen buttons, **Tablet buttons** and wheels.



More › About

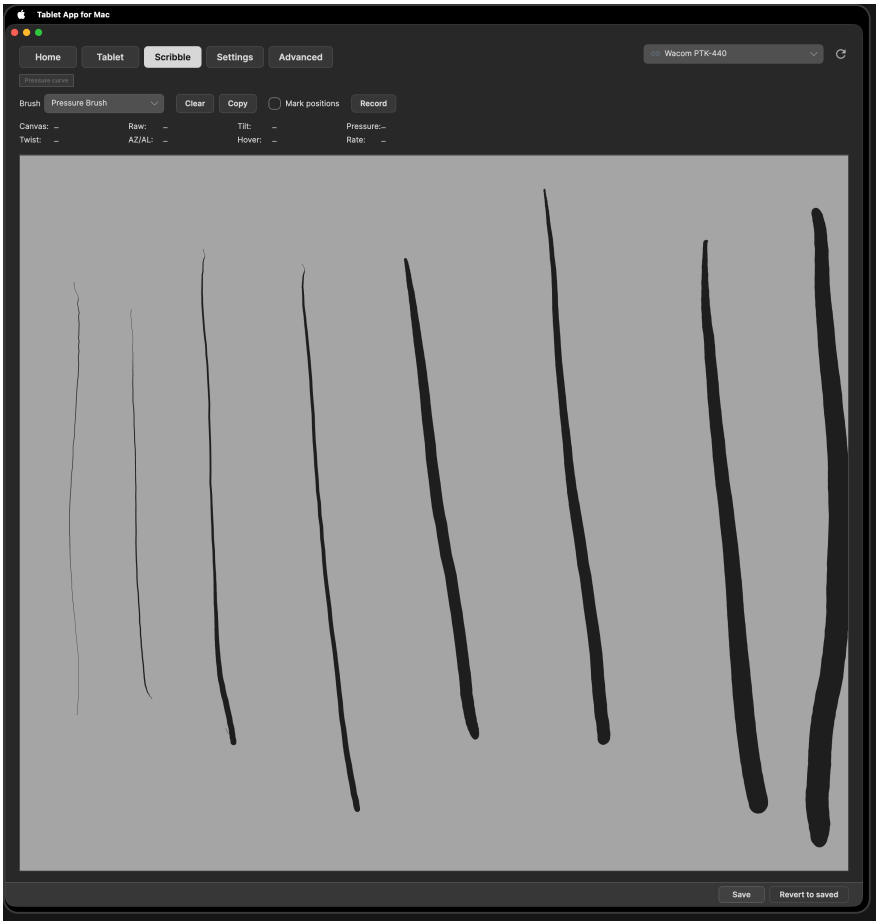
- **calibration**: **Start** shows full-screen targets; tap each, then **Apply**. **More calibration actions**: **View report…**, **Export calibration…**, **Import calibration…**, **Clear calibration**. The on/off switch compares with and without the correction. Calibrate only if the pointer sits away from the nib.
- **hover** (below): hover limit, off by default; 127 when first switched on (0 to 255). Stops cursor tracking past this distance.
- **filters**: the OpenTabletDriver filters on this tablet.
- **json**: the profile as the daemon stores it.



More › Hover

Scribble

A test canvas with a precise crosshair cursor. Draws with the processed pressure, so the curve, Disable pen tip and the Manual Pressure are visible.



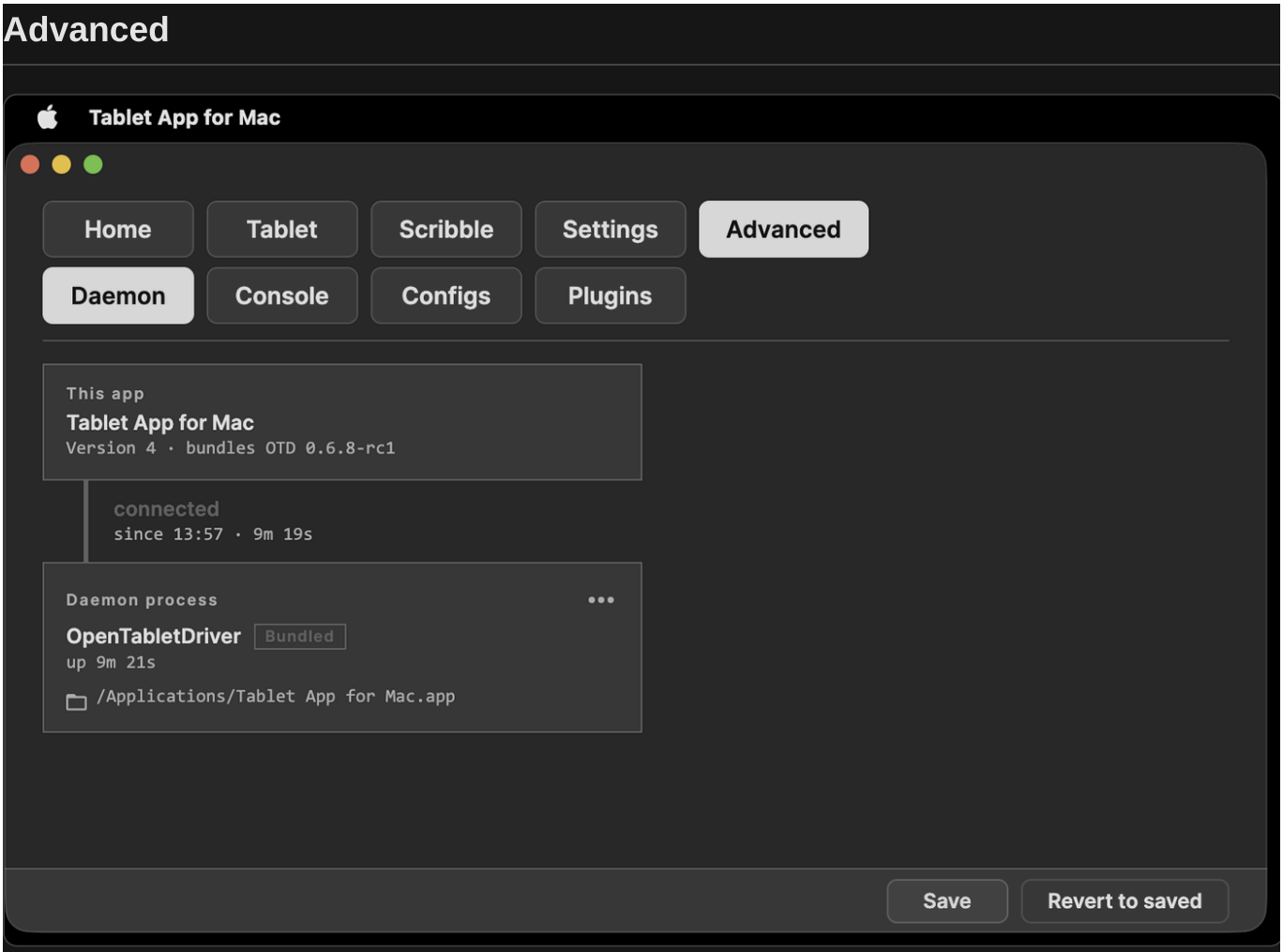
Scribble

Mark positions dots each report. **Clear**, **Copy**. **Record** and **Stop** save a stroke recording.

Settings

- **Theme**: **Themes** (Graphite, Silver, Charcoal, Rose, Burgundy, Custom, System; default Graphite), brightness, **Backdrops** (Solid colour, Generated gradient, **Add glow**, **Choose image…**), **Colours** (Highlight colour, Card colour). **Reset to defaults**.
- **Hotkeys**: global shortcuts for tablet actions and **Load a preset**. **Assign…**, **Clear**. Default: not set.
- **Presets**: see Presets and saving.
- **System**: **Open Login Items…** to start the app at login.

Advanced



Advanced › Daemon

- **Daemon**: status; **Start**, **Restart**, **Stop**, **Open OpenTabletDriver's interface**, **Open the folder holding this daemon**.
- **Plugins**: **Rescan plugin folder**, **Open plugin folder**.
- **Tablet configs**: **Check for more configs**, **Install**, **View**.
- **Console**: severity filter, text filter, **Auto-scroll** (on), copy as text, Markdown or HTML, **Clear**.
- **Diagnostics**: **Start** and **Stop** live reports.

About and Options

About shows the version and links: **Get help** (this manual), **Supported tablets**, **Source code**, **Releases**, **User manual**, **Credits and licences**, **Feedback**. Feedback is read once a week. **Options…** opens Settings.

Presets and saving

- Changes apply at once; the footer shows **Save** and **Revert to saved** while there are unsaved changes.
- **Save** writes the settings. **Revert to saved** goes back to the last save.
- After a shutdown or crash with unsaved changes, the app offers the snapshot again at the next launch.
- **Save as preset** stores the whole configuration under a name. Preset ⋯: **Update from current settings**, **Duplicate**, **Rename…**, **Delete**. **Load** applies it.

Quitting

- **Cmd+Q** closes the window. The app stays in the menu bar and the tablet keeps working.
- **Quit** in the menu bar menu stops the app and its daemon. With unsaved changes it asks "Save changes before quitting?": **Cancel** keeps the app open, **Don't Save** quits without saving, **Save** saves and quits.
- Quitting also happens at shutdown and logout; unsaved changes are then kept and offered at the next launch.

Tested system and tablet

macOS 27.0.1 on Apple silicon, Wacom Intuos4 Small (PTK-440). Nothing else has been tested.

Wacom driver conflict

The Wacom driver and OpenTabletDriver cannot both use the tablet. Quit or uninstall the Wacom driver before using this app. Home shows a warning while it is running.

Updating

- Replace the app in Applications with the new build.
- macOS may treat the new build as a different app. If the tablet stops responding, in System Settings › Privacy & Security remove the app from **Input Monitoring** and **Accessibility** with **−**, add it again with **+**, and relaunch.

Going back to an earlier build

Download the earlier build from Releases and replace the app. Settings are kept. Re-add the permissions as under Updating if needed.

Uninstalling

- Quit from the menu bar.
- Delete the app from Applications.
- Remove its entries from **Input Monitoring** and **Accessibility** with **−**.
- Remove its Login Item if you added one.
- Optional: delete its settings folder in ~/Library/Application Support.

Credits and licences

Tablet App for Mac is a modified version of OpenTabletArtist by TheSevenPens (GPL-3.0) and uses OpenTabletDriver (LGPL-3.0). The full list of packages and licence texts is on the Credits and licences page.

Glossary

- **Tip Feel**: the pressure curve, from Soft to Firm.
- **Touch Ring modes**: up to four sets of ring actions, switched with the centre button.
- **Preset**: a named copy of the whole configuration.
- **Application row**: per-app settings; **All** applies everywhere else.
- **Shared with Pen**: an Eraser setting that is the same setting as on the Pen tab.

Not written here

Troubleshooting and the per-app notes (Photoshop, Affinity, PhotoCraft) are written separately. Per-app shortcuts: not yet tested.